

Sungmin Kang

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Updated on 2026-08-28

EDUCATION

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology

Mar. 2014 – Aug. 2024

- Integrated Ph.D. in Computer Science (2019 – 2024)
- B.S. in Computer Science (2014 – 2019)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

NUS Trustworthy and Secure Software Lab.

Mar. 2025 – Present

Research Fellow

- Project: Enhancing Trust in Agentic Software Systems
- Supervisor: Prof. Abhik Roychoudhury
- Research Areas: LLM Agents, Automatic Debugging

KAIST Computational Intelligence for Software Engineering Lab.

Sept. 2018 – Feb. 2025

Graduate Student, then Postdoctoral Researcher

- Thesis: Reliable Large Language Model-based Software Artifacts via Execution
- Supervisor: Prof. Shin Yoo
- Research Areas: Software Testing, Automatic Debugging

Microsoft Research Asia

Oct. 2022 – Apr. 2023

Research Intern

- Project: Explainable Automated Debugging via Large Language Models
- Supervisor: Dr. Jian-guang Lou
- Research Areas: Language Models, Automated Program Repair

PUBLICATIONS

Asterisks (*) denote equal contribution.

CONFERENCES

[1] **Sungmin Kang***, Haifeng Ruan*, Abhik Roychoudhury, “AutoCodeSherpa: Symbolic Explanations in AI Coding Agents”, **ISSTA’26**.

[2] Zhiyuan Pan*, **Sungmin Kang***, Imam Nur Bani Yusuf*, Abhik Roychoudhury, “ExplainBench: Evaluating Code Explanations from Agents”, **ASE’26**.

[3] **Sungmin Kang**, Sumi Yun, Jingun Hong, Shin Yoo, Gabin An, “Finding the Needle in the Crash Stack: Industrial-Scale Crash Root Cause Localization with AutoCrashFL”, **ICSE SEIP’26**.

[4] Louis Milliken, **Sungmin Kang**, Shin Yoo, “Beyond pip install: Evaluating LLM Agents for the Automated Installation of Python Projects”, **SANER’25**.

[5] **Sungmin Kang***, Gabin An*, Shin Yoo, “A Quantitative and Qualitative Evaluation of LLM-based Fault Localization”, **FSE’24**.

[6] **Sungmin Kang***, Wonkeun Choi*, Shin Yoo, “A Bayesian Framework for Automated Debugging”, **ISSTA’23**.

[7] **Sungmin Kang***, Juyeon Yoon*, Shin Yoo, “Large Language Models are Few-shot Testers: Exploring LLM-based General Bug Reproduction”, **ICSE’23**.

JOURNALS

[1] **Sungmin Kang**, Bei Chen, Shin Yoo, Jian-guang Lou, “Explainable Automated Debugging via Large Language Model-driven Scientific Debugging”, **Empirical Software Engineering** 30.2 (2025).

[2] **Sungmin Kang***, Juyeon Yoon*, Nargiz Askarbekkyzy, Shin Yoo, “Evaluating Diverse Large Language Models for Automatic and General Bug Reproduction”, **IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering** 50.10 (2024).

[3] **Sungmin Kang**, Robert Feldt, Shin Yoo, “Deceiving Humans and Machines Alike: Search-based Test Input Generation for DNNs using Variational Autoencoders”, **ACM Transactions on Software Engineering and Methodology** 33.4 (2024).

[4] Jeongju Sohn*, **Sungmin Kang***, Shin Yoo, “Arachne: Search Based Repair of Deep Neural Networks”, **ACM Transactions on Software Engineering and Methodology** 32.4 (2023).

[5] Kyeong Min Song, Shinho Kim, **Sungmin Kang**, Tae Won Nam, Geon Yeong Kim, Hunhee Lim, Eugene N. Cho, Kwang Ho Kim, Se Hun Kwon, Min Seok Jang et al., “Microcellular sensing media with ternary transparency states for fast and intuitive identification of unknown liquids”, **Science Advances** 7.38 (2021).

[6] Koeun Han, Hee-Jin Jeong, Hee-Bum Yang, **Sung-Min Kang**, Jin-Kyung Kwon, Seungill Kim, Doil Choi, and Byoung-Cheorl Kang, “An ultra-high-density bin map facilitates high-throughput QTL mapping of horticultural traits in pepper”, **DNA Research** 23.2 (2016).

WORKSHOPS AND SHORT PAPERS

[1] Jae Yong Lee, **Sungmin Kang**, Shin Yoo, “Predictive Prompt Analysis”, FSE’25 Ideas, Visions and Reflections track.

[2] Naryeong Kim, **Sungmin Kang**, Gabin An, Shin Yoo, “Lachesis: Predicting LLM Inference Accuracy using Structural Properties of Reasoning Paths”, ICSE’25 Workshop on Deep Learning for Testing and Testing for Deep Learning, short paper.

[3] Hyunjoon Cho, **Sungmin Kang**, Gabin An, Shin Yoo, “COSMosFL: Ensemble of Small Language Models for Fault Localisation”, ICSE’25 Workshop on Large Language Models for Code.

[4] Jae Yong Lee, **Sungmin Kang**, Juyeon Yoon, Shin Yoo, “The GitHub Recent Bugs Dataset for Evaluating LLM-based Debugging Applications”, ICST’24 Demonstration track.

[5] Robert Feldt, **Sungmin Kang**, Juyeon Yoon, Shin Yoo, “SOCRATEST - Towards Autonomous Testing Agents via Conversational Large Language Models”, ASE’23 New Ideas and Emerging Results track.

[6] **Sungmin Kang**, Shin Yoo, “GLAD: Neural Predicate Synthesis to Repair Omission Faults”, ICSE’23 poster track.

[7] **Sungmin Kang**, Shin Yoo, “Towards Objective-Tailored Genetic Improvement Through Large Language Models”, GI’23 position paper.

- [8] **Sungmin Kang**, Shin Yoo, “Language Models Can Prioritize Patches for Practical Program Patching”, ICSE’22 Workshop on Automated Program Repair.
- [9] **Sungmin Kang**, Shin Yoo, “Improving Fault Localization and Automated Program Repair with Suspicious Predicates”, KCSE’22 short paper.
- [10] **Sungmin Kang**, Robert Feldt, Shin Yoo, “SINVAD: Search-based Image Space Navigation for DNN Image Classifier Test Input Generation”, ICSE’20 Workshop on Search-based Software Testing.
- [11] **Sungmin Kang**, Jaegul Choo, and Jaehyuk Chang, “Consistent Comic Colorization with Pixel-wise Background Classification”, NIPS’17 Workshop on Machine Learning for Creativity and Design, poster track.

SERVICE

Chair

Chair for ICST’26 Artifact Evaluation Track

Journal Reviewer

Reviewer for TSE (2023–2026), TOSEM (2023–2026), EMSE (2025–2026), JSS, ASE, etc.

Conference Program Committee

PC member for ICSE (2026–2027), FSE (2027), ASE (2026), ISSRE (2024–2025), SSBSE (2025), etc.

PATENTS

- Method for coloring a target image, and device and computer program therefor, US Patent 12056801
- Method, apparatus, and computer program for completing painting of image, and method, apparatus, and computer program for training artificial neural network, US Patent 11887224
- Method and apparatus for operating benchmark system of software-debugging, US Patent App. 19/206,686 (pending)

INVITED TALKS

- **LLM-based Software Testing and Bug Analysis**
Talk at National Research Council of Science and Technology (2025).
- **Explainable Program Repair with Automated Scientific Debugging**
Talk at Dagstuhl Seminar on Automated Programming and Program Repair (2024).
- **Towards Reliable LLM-based Software Generation and Debugging**
Talk at NUS (2024), Georgia Tech (2024), Korea University (2025).
- **The State-of-the-art in LLM-based SE techniques: From Bug Reproduction to Program Repair**
Talk given at SAP Korea and SureSoft (2023).

AWARDS

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| Distinguished Reviewer Award (International Conference on Software Engineering 2026) | 2026 |
| For reviewing activity serving as a member of the program committee at ICSE | |
| Distinguished Dissertation Award (KAIST School of Computing) | 2025 |
| For doctoral thesis on Reliable LLM-based Software Artifacts | |
| Best Position Paper Award (International Workshop on Genetic Improvement 2023) | 2023 |
| For the paper “Towards Objective-Tailored Genetic Improvement Through Large Language Models” | |

Best Presentation Award (International Workshop on Genetic Improvement 2023) 2023
For the paper “Towards Objective-Tailored Genetic Improvement Through Large Language Models”

Best Short Paper Award (Korea Conference on Software Engineering 2022) 2022
For the paper “Improving Fault Localization and Automated Program Repair with Suspicious Predicates”

Excellent Teaching Assistant Award (KAIST School of Computing) 2019
As an assistant of the “AI Based Software Engineering” course

SKILLS

Natural Languages

Korean (native), English (native)

Programming Languages

Fluent in Python, familiar with C, Java, bash.